

Photographs by MAHADEO SEN



Rs 400 crore

is the value of overseas investments allegedly made by Jharkhand's former chief minister Madhu Koda in countries as far as Singapore, Thailand, Dubai and Liberia.

5 former ministers in Koda's team—Kamlesh Singh, Bhanu Pratap Shahi, Anosh Ekka, Harinarayan Rai and Bandhu Tirkey—have also been booked by the Enforcement Directorate.

Rs 6.14 lakh

is the amount in Indian and foreign currencies with which Koda's frontman Sanjay Choudhary was detained at Mumbai airport.

Dubai to Liberia. His downslide had begun when Jharkhand Mukti Morcha President Shibu Soren dethroned him and took over the reins of the state in August 2008. Soren, however, had to resign following his defeat in the January Tamar by-poll. With the Assembly in suspended animation, Jharkhand has been under President's rule since January 19. The former ministers in Koda's team who have been booked are Kamlesh Singh, Bhanu Pratap Shahi, Anosh Ekka, Harinarayan Rai and Bandhu Tirkey, all accused of amassing disproportionate assets.

The ED has also filed cases against Vinod Sinha and Sanjay Choudhary, alleged Koda frontmen. In fact, the ED appears to have initiated their investigations from where to a large extent the Jharkhand Vigilance Bureau (VB) concluded collecting "evidences" against all six former VIPs, including Koda who once had carte blanche to twine the entire state around his little finger. The ED got in touch with the state VB in July this year soon after the latter lodged separate FIRs against Koda and his former cabinet colleagues. The ED specifically sought to share details with the VB for its own investigations on money laundering.

**THE ED CRACK-
DOWN ON HIS
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TURNED
KODA'S ONCE
PROMISING
POLITICAL
CAREER
UPSIDE DOWN**